

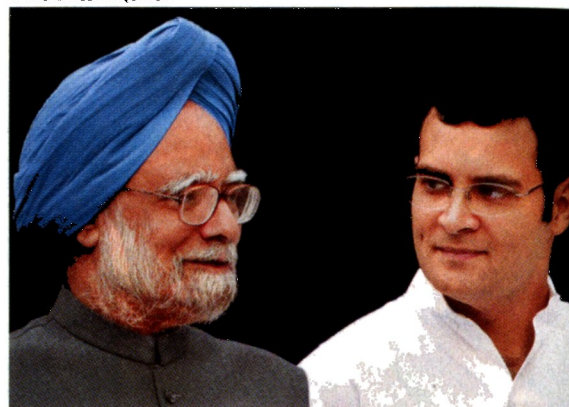
THE RANKINGS

Score (%)

1	P. CHIDAMBARAM Minister of Home Affairs	65
2	PRANAB MUKHERJEE Minister of Finance	63
3	KAPIL SIBAL Minister of Human Resource Development	62
4	ANAND SHARMA Minister of Commerce and Industry	61
5	M. VEERAPPA MOILY Minister of Law and Justice	59
6	C.P. JOSHI Minister of Rural Development and Minister of Panchayati Raj	57
7	AMBIKA SONI Minister of Information and Broadcasting	55
8	PRITHVIRAJ CHAVAN Minister of Science and Technology; MoS for Earth Sciences; MoS in the Prime Minister's Office; MoS in the Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions; MoS in the Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs	53
9	M.S. GILL Minister of Youth Affairs and Sports	51
10	SUSHILKUMAR SHINDE Minister of Power	49
11	JAIRAM RAMESH MoS for Environment and Forests	48
12	MUKUL WASNIK Minister of Social Justice and Empowerment	47
13	S.M. KRISHNA Minister of External Affairs	45
14	SHARAD PAWAR Minister of Agriculture and Minister of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution	41
15	KAMAL NATH Minister of Road Transport and Highways	40
16	FAROOQ ABDULLAH Minister of New and Renewable Energy	39
17	A.K. ANTONY Minister of Defence	38
18	VIRBHADRA SINGH Minister of Steel	37
19	S. JAIPAL REDDY Minister of Urban Development	36
20	DAYANIDHI MARAN Minister of Textiles	36
21	KUMARI SELJA Minister of Housing and Urban Poverty Alleviation and Minister of Tourism	34
22	SALMAN KHURSHED MoS for Corporate Affairs and MoS for Minority Affairs	34
23	MURLI DEORA Minister of Petroleum and Natural Gas	34
24	G.K. VASAN Minister of Shipping	33
25	MALLIKARJUN KHARGE Minister of Labour and Employment	32
26	B.K. HANDIQUE Minister of Mines and Minister of Development of North-Eastern Region	32
27	PAWAN K. BANSAL Minister of Parliamentary Affairs and Minister of Water Resources	32
28	PRAFUL PATEL MoS for Civil Aviation	32
29	GHULAM NABI AZAD Minister of Health and Family Welfare	32
30	VAYALAR RAVI Minister of Overseas Indian Affairs	32
31	SHRIPRAKASH JAISWAL MoS for Coal and MoS for Statistics and Programme Implementation	32
32	SUBODH KANT SAHAY Minister of Food Processing Industries	31
33	VILASRAO DESHMUKH Minister of Heavy Industries and Public Enterprises	30
34	MAMATA BANERJEE Minister of Railways	30
35	KANTILAL BHURIA Minister of Tribal Affairs	29
36	A. RAJA Minister of Communications and Information Technology	29
37	DINSHA J. PATEL MoS for Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises	28
38	KRISHNA TIRATH MoS for Women and Child Development	28
39	M. K. ALAGIRI Minister of Chemicals and Fertilisers	28

MoS: Minister of State with Independent Charge

AP PHOTO/MUSTAFA QURAISHI


MANMOHAN WITH RAHUL GANDHI (RIGHT)

political. The best cure for some infections is sunlight, public exposure. In the next 100 days, Manmohan may want to list five-point key achievable targets for each ministry with a deadline. Non-performers must be named and shamed. It will also afford an opportunity to blood fresh talent.

Leadership, by definition, is not consensus. It is finally about getting a group to buy into ideas and then work as a team. UPA II is anything but a team given the raging civil war within the Government with ministers battling on issues ranging from climate change to Bt Brinjal to tackling the Maoist menace. Sure, the arithmetic of politics precludes Manmohan from choosing his team but he should have the freedom to boot out the corrupt and the slovenly. UPA II is replete with ministers who put politics over their duties, and those who prefer to operate from their states and those who play truant during crucial meetings. The joke doing the rounds in South Block is that UPA II is infested with ministers wanting to head another ministry, of ministers who would rather be chief ministers in their states. In terms of talent and experience, you couldn't ask for more. No other Government has had nine former chief ministers in the Cabinet. But what do they have to show for their experience in terms of performance?

Manmohan has to compete with his own halo of the man who freed the economy from the bondage of licence raj. What he did as finance minister continues to outshine his achievements as prime minister. His challenge is to outdo the Manmohan of the '90s by liberating India from the sloth that characterises governance. ■

If you want to rank the ministers visit:
www.indiatoday.in/rank

